



FOCUS FLOW · THERAPY

Quick Start Guide

from download to your first check-in in 3 minutes



FOCUS FLOW THERAPY

Today 3

Thought records

Coping box

Sessions

Summary

Settings

Sam's therapy
Your data lives only on this device. [Shortcuts ?](#)

Good morning, Sam.

Checked in · mood 5/5 · anxiety 1/5 · session in 5 days.

Check in + Thought record

Right now

Pick what's happening. The app suggests what has worked for you before.

anxious sad angry ashamed guilty overwhelmed

rejected hopeless frustrated scared lonely numb

Feeling anxious.

What has helped you most: Cold water on wrists / face -4.0

Box breathing 4-4-4-4 -3.7 10-minute walk, no phone -3.5

Write it down (thought record) Coping box

Bring up next session

3

☐ The thing with my sister at lunch — went quiet for two days after · Sep 8

☐ Sleep is the biggest mood predictor this month — can we work on it? · Sep 12

☐ Meds feel weaker in the afternoon · Sep 14

the thing with my sister · the Sund. Add

Sessions

Next Mon, Sep 21 5 pm

Last Aug 31

Homework One thought record per week. Text Ana a low-effort plan.

If it's bad right now

Feelings are weather, not facts. Cold water, one slow breath out, one safe person. If you are in danger, call your local emergency number or a crisis line — this app is a notebook, not a service.

Last 14 days

Mood: red ≤2 · yellow 3 · green ≥4 · grey = no check-in. Tap a day to fill it in.

avg mood 3.6 check-ins 12/14 thought records 5 skills used 5

Focus Flow Therapy v1.0

a therapy journal and CBT toolkit: guided thought records, a coping-skills box that suggests what worked before, session notes with "bring this up next time", mood and trigger check-ins, and a between-sessions summary you can share with your therapist.



Hi. This will be quick.

Focus Flow Therapy is a real app that lives in a single file. There is no account, no server and nothing to install. A 30-second daily check-in, a guided seven-step thought record for when a thought has its claws in, a coping box that learns which skills work for you, a queue of things to bring up next session, and a one-screen summary of everything since last time. That's the whole method. It is a notebook, not a service, and never a replacement for a therapist or a crisis line.

Everything you type stays on your device. Nobody can see it — not us, not anyone. The trade-off is that **you** are in charge of backups (see "Your data"). It's one tap; the app reminds you.

What's in your download

FILE	WHAT IT IS
Focus-Flow-Therapy.html	The app. Keep this file somewhere safe (your Documents folder is perfect).
Focus-Flow-Therapy-Quick-Start-Guide.pdf	This guide.
README.txt	The two-line version of this guide, with your iPhone link.

The 3-minute start

- 1 Unzip the download.** Windows: right-click → Extract All. Mac: double-click the ZIP.
- 2 Open Focus-Flow-Therapy.html.** Double-click it. If it opens in the wrong program, right-click → Open with → Chrome / Edge / Firefox / Safari.
- 3 Bookmark it** (Ctrl/Cmd + D) so it's one click away from now on.
- 4 Answer 3 quick questions:** your name and therapist, your coping skills, how it works. Or tap *"Explore with example data"* first.
- 5 Check in** once a day (button, or **c**). **Thought record** when it bites (**n**).



Nothing you do here is permanent. Every delete has an Undo. "Start fresh" is always in Settings. Play.

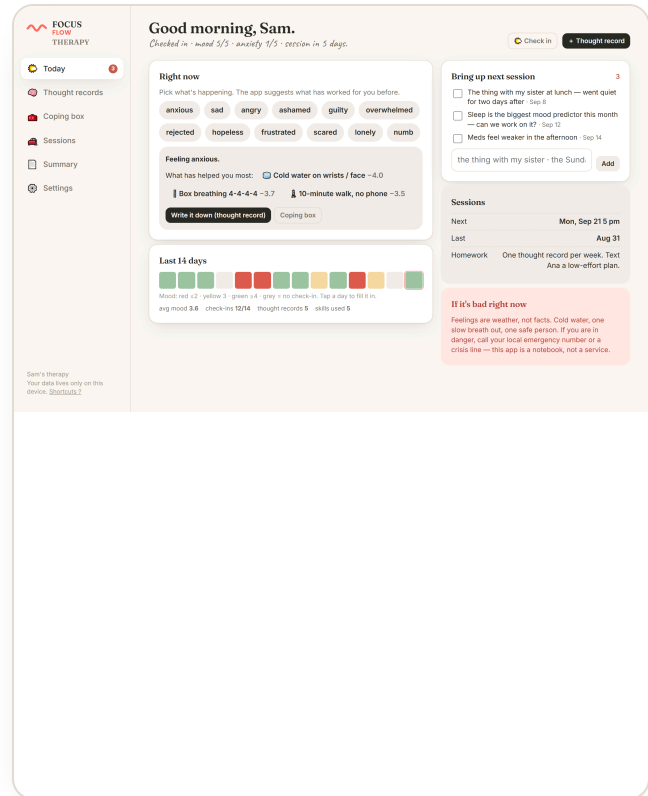
Right now, the last 14 days, next session

Right now: tap the feeling — anxious, sad, angry, ashamed, guilty, overwhelmed, rejected, hopeless, frustrated, scared, lonely, numb. The app shows the coping skills that have worked best for you (by your own before → after ratings), a button to write it down as a thought record, and the coping box.

Last 14 days is your mood strip — red, yellow, green, grey for no check-in — with averages and counts. Tap a day to fill it in late.

Bring up next session is the queue for the things you notice on Tuesday and forget on the sofa on Thursday. Tick them off after the session. **Sessions** shows the next date and the current homework.

Press **c** to check in, **n** for a thought record.



Seven steps, five minutes

1 · What happened, just the facts. 2 · The thought that showed up. 3 · Feelings (chips) and how strong, 0–10. 4 · Thinking traps in it — eleven chips with a one-line explanation each: all-or-nothing, catastrophising, mind reading, discounting positives, emotional reasoning, overgeneralising, personalising, magnifying. 5 · Evidence the thought is true. 6 · Evidence it isn't — what would you tell a friend? 7 · A fairer, kinder thought. Then how strong now, 0–10.

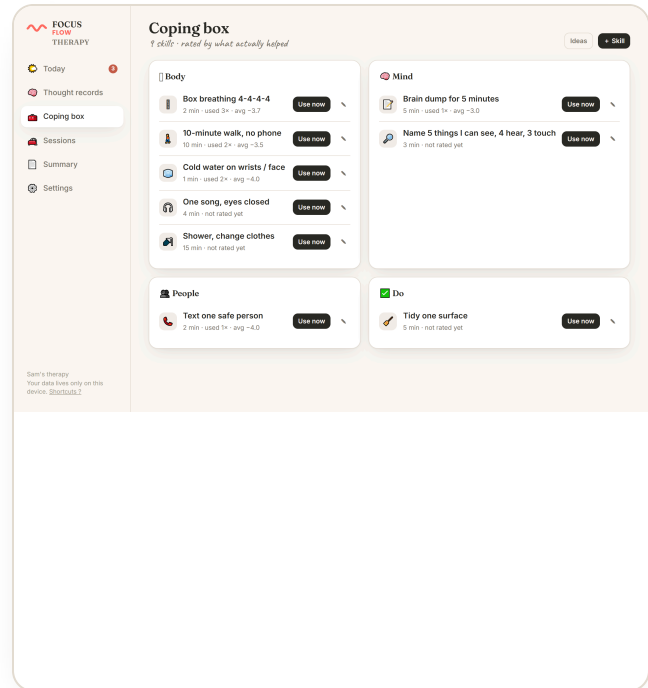
The Records screen lists them all, shows **your usual distortions** ranked (knowing your favourite two is half the work), and the **average drop** in intensity — evidence, in your own numbers, that writing it down works.

Rated by what actually helped

Twelve ideas to start — body (box breathing, cold water, a walk, a shower, a hug), mind (brain dump, 5-4-3 grounding, say it in a silly voice, two minutes of nothing), people (text one safe person), do (tidy one surface) — each with a rough time. Delete what isn't you; add your own.

Use now asks how you feel before (0–10), lets you do it, asks after. Each use is logged; the box shows "used 4× · avg -3.5". That is how Today knows what to suggest for "anxious" — your history, not a generic list.

Rate honestly, including the times it didn't help.
A skill with "-0.5" is one to replace.



Two minutes in the car park

Sessions

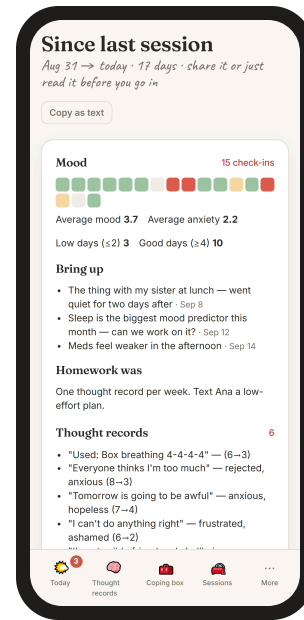
Date and time. After each: what we talked about, what landed (the sentence you want to keep), homework, and how it felt 1–5. Adding a past session with notes clears the "bring up" items from before it.

Summary

Everything since the last logged session on one screen: the mood strip with averages and low/good day counts, the things to bring up, the current homework, the thought records with before → after, your distortions, which skills helped, triggers noted, and your one-line notes.

Copy as text to read in the waiting room or send ahead if your therapist likes that.

If you are in danger or thinking of harming yourself, call your local emergency number or a crisis line. This app is a notebook.



Where your data lives, and how to keep it safe

The app saves automatically to your browser's local storage on this device. It never sends anything anywhere. That means two things:

✓ Private by design

No account, no password, no email, no tracking. Closing the tab, restarting the computer, going offline — all fine, your data is still there when you come back.

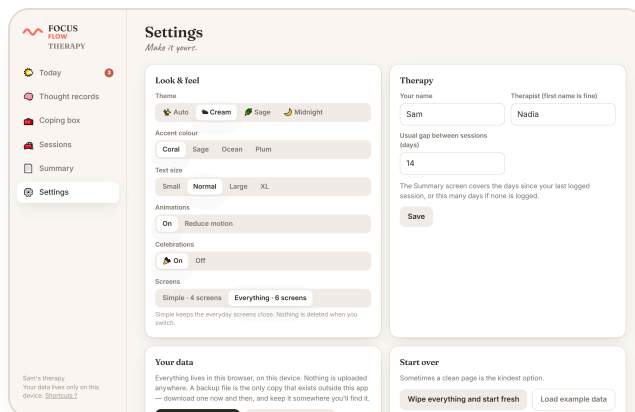
⚠ Backups are yours to make

Clearing browser data, using a private/incognito window, or some "cleaner" apps can wipe local storage. So, once in a while (the app reminds you after 14 days of changes):

- 1 Settings → **Download backup**. A small .json file lands in your Downloads.
- 2 Move it somewhere you'll find it (a folder, or your cloud drive).
- 3 To restore — on this or any other device — Settings → **Restore a backup** and pick the file.

Encrypted backups

Settings → **Encrypted backup** locks the file with a passphrase you choose (AES-256). Perfect for cloud drives. There is no reset — if you lose the passphrase, nobody can open it, not even us.



Using the app in a private/incognito window will lose your data when the window closes. Use a normal window.

Sharing a home or a household? Each person opens the file in their own browser profile — data is kept separately.

Opening the app on each device

DEVICE	HOW
Windows	Keep the .html file in Documents. Double-click → opens in Edge or Chrome. Bookmark it. Optional: in Edge/Chrome, menu → "Install page as app" / "Create shortcut" → it gets its own window and icon.
Mac	Keep the file in Documents. Double-click → Safari (or right-click → Open With → Chrome). Bookmark it, or drag the address bar icon to the Dock.
Chromebook / Linux	Open the file in Chrome from the Files app. Bookmark it.
Android	Copy the file to your phone (email it to yourself, or use Google Drive → Download). Open it with Chrome from the Files app. Chrome menu : → Add to Home screen gives you an app icon.
iPhone / iPad	Open https://pablo96si.github.io/focusflow-therapy/ in Safari. Tap the Share button (the square with an arrow) → Add to Home Screen → Add. You now have a Focus Flow icon that opens full-screen, works offline and keeps your data on your phone. The link only serves the app — nothing you type is sent to it. Please keep the link private; it is part of your purchase.

The web-app link works everywhere

The same link also works in Chrome on Android (menu : → Add to Home screen), in Edge/Chrome on Windows (Install app) and in Safari on Mac. Use the file or the link — whichever you prefer. Data is stored separately in each, so pick one and use a backup file to move between them.

Moving to a new device

Old device: Settings → Download backup. New device: open the app → Settings → Restore a backup. Two minutes.

Updates

Re-download from your Etsy purchases page any time. Open the new file, then Restore a backup if your data isn't already there.

Little questions, quick answers

I'm not in therapy. Is it still useful?

Yes — thought records, the coping box and daily check-ins are self-help CBT tools. Leave the sessions screen empty, or use it for GP visits.

Is it private?

Completely. It lives in this file on this device. No account, no sync, no analytics. Back it up somewhere only you control; the encrypted backup uses a passphrase.

DBT, ACT, not CBT?

The coping box and check-ins are approach-neutral. The thought record is classic CBT; use step 7 for defusion or self-compassion phrases if that fits better.

Can I share the summary with my therapist?

Copy as text and send it however you already communicate — or just read it before the session. Your call, every time.

Something looks wrong on my screen.

Try a different browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox and Safari are all supported), and make sure it's up to date. Then message us on Etsy with a screenshot — we answer.

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